

MadeByKreative — Action Checklist

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A friendly to-do list for Kristol. Copy-paste the titles & tags straight into Etsy. Full reasoning & data: [etsy-optimization.md](#) (overall) and [banner-pricing-deep-dive.pdf](#) (pricing). Editable calculators: [etsy-pricing-model.csv](#), [banner-cost-model.csv](#).

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♥ **First, the big thing: you're doing a wonderful job.** Your shop converts at about **5.7%** — roughly *double* the typical Etsy shop — your bestsellers **sell out**, and shoppers have left you 5-star reviews and **386 favorites** this year. That's the hard part of running a handmade shop, and you've already nailed it. Everything below is just **polish on top of something that's clearly working** — and the theme is simple: since you make every piece by hand and won't cut corners, let's make sure **each one earns what it's truly worth**, rather than chasing more orders than you can comfortably sew. Quality over quantity, paid properly. Pick whatever feels easy; none of it is urgent.

★ The big picture (the good news)

1. **You make things people love — they sell out.** Your patriotic / 4th-of-July rag garlands are ~70% of your year and sell out every season. The opportunity: make a few extra next year so you never have to turn a sale away. 🌟
2. **Your work may be worth more than you're charging.** You already price bigger sizes higher (smart! — and we fixed a little website glitch that was hiding that). The lovely surprise: when you add up fabric, your time, and Etsy's fees, your banners are a genuine **bargain** — priced *below* what comparable shops charge, even though yours sell out. That's a great position to be in: it means there's comfortable room to **gently raise prices and pay yourself more for work you're already doing**. Suggested prices are in the next section.
3. **Your time is the real limit — so aim for profit *per piece*, not just more sales.** You make every banner by hand, and that quality is your whole magic — please don't change it. But it also means there are only so many hours in your week. Since you already sell out, the smartest growth isn't squeezing in *more* orders — it's earning **more from each one** (by

pricing fairly and spending your sewing time on the pieces that pay best — see "Make your time count" below).

4. **Pinterest is quietly your best friend.** It brings nearly all your outside-of-Etsy traffic (Instagram/Facebook barely register). Leaning into Pinterest is a great, low-effort win.
5. **Working one season ahead is the real secret.** Your shop lives and dies by the calendar, and shoppers buy decor a month or two *before* each holiday. Right now (June) the season to get ready for is **Fall / Halloween** — see the calendar near the bottom. Everything else can happily wait its turn.

\$ Pricing — a friendly raise (you've earned it)

Here's the happy part: **your work is worth more than you're charging.** Your sizes are already priced just right relative to each other — the only opportunity is to nudge the overall prices up toward what comparable shops get, while *still* being a great deal for your customers. These suggested prices give your time the credit it deserves, and even at these numbers you'd remain **at or below most competitors** (full breakdown in [banner-pricing-deep-dive.pdf](#)). Take them as a starting point and adjust to whatever feels comfortable.

Banners — suggested prices

Banner	Now (by size)	New (by size)
Rag garland — Halloween, Fall, Spring	4ft \$15 · 5ft \$17.50 · 6ft \$20	4ft \$18 · 5ft \$22 · 6ft \$26
St. Patrick's rag garland	3ft \$12 · 4ft \$15 · 5ft \$17.50 · 6ft \$20	3ft \$15 · 4ft \$18 · 5ft \$22 · 6ft \$26
Regular pennant — Easter, Valentine, St. Pat's	48in \$16 · 67–68in \$20	48in \$20 · 67–68in \$28
Medium pennant — Christmas, Gingerbread	48in \$14 · 67in \$18	48in \$18 · 67in \$24
Mini pennant — St. Patrick's	48in \$10 · 72in \$15	48in \$12 · 72in \$20
Bow garland — Fall	36in \$20 · 70in \$25	36in \$20 (keep) · 70in \$30
Birthday bunting (both, Orange & Lime)	\$15 (one size)	\$22 (<i>optionally add a 48in \$16 size</i>)

Accessories

Listing	Now	New
Fabric Wristlet Keychain (all colors)	\$8	\$12 (<i>it's a real steal at \$8 — \$12 is still very fair, and similar ones go for \$11+</i>)

If you only change three things

1. **Birthday buntings** → **\$22**. These are a full-size 73" banner currently priced like a small one — so this is the easiest, no-risk win on the list. 📌
2. **Rag garlands up a few dollars per size**. They're your bestsellers *and* a bargain next to the competition — so this is where a small raise adds up the most.
3. **Give the largest pennants a few more dollars** (regular 67" → \$28, medium 67" → \$24, mini 72" → \$20). The big sizes are the most work, so they've more than earned it.

An easy, low-stress way to do it

- Raise **6–8 weeks before each season** (when shoppers are already searching) — increases feel natural then, and you're riding rising demand rather than discounting into it.
- Try the **largest size first** and peek at your conversion rate for a week or two — your Etsy stats will show you it's holding (and it should; your items sell out). Then do the rest with confidence.
- Keep one **budget-friendly size** per product (small mini ~\$12, small rag \$18) so price-conscious shoppers still have a way in.

These come from a real cost build-up (materials + your time + shipping + Etsy fees) cross-checked against competitor prices. The materials/time figures are estimates — if you tell me your real fabric cost and minutes-per-banner, the numbers in banner-cost-model.csv recalculate exactly.

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Make your time count (what's worth sewing)

Because you make everything by hand and keep the quality high, **your time — not customer demand — is what limits the shop**. So the goal isn't making *more* (you already sell out); it's making sure **every hour at the sewing table earns as much as it can**. Two levers do that: the price raises above, and choosing *what* to spend your hours on.

Here's what each piece earns **per hour of your time at the new prices** (after fabric & Etsy fees):

♥ Worth your time most	~\$/hr	🤔 Time-sinks to rethink	~\$/hr
Bow garland (either size)	~\$19	Mini pennant 48"	~\$8
Small rag garland (3–4 ft)	~\$17–19	Birthday bunting	~\$9
Rag garland 5–6 ft	~\$15–16	Mini pennant 72"	~\$11
Medium / regular pennants	~\$13–14		

What this means for where your hours go:

- **Lean into rag garlands and bow garlands.** They're your bestsellers *and* your best earners per hour — the happiest combination. When you have making time, make these first. ❤️
- **The little mini pennants and the Birthday banner pay the least for the time they take** (lots of tiny pennants / HTV lettering for not much). You don't have to drop them — just don't pour stock hours into them. Gentle options: make them **"made to order" only**, **simplify** them (fewer, larger pennants), nudge their price up a touch more, or quietly **retire** any that rarely sell.
- **Save minutes without losing quality** — this is the no-outsourcing way to give yourself a raise: cut fabric in **batches**, **chain-sew** pennants assembly-line style, and make a **production run** of each season's bestseller *before* the rush instead of one at a time. Trimming even 10 minutes off a banner is a real raise.
- **Don't pay to be busier.** Etsy will nudge you toward ads and sales to chase *more* orders — but when you already sell out, that just means more work at the same (or lower) profit. Your path to more money is **more profit per piece**, not more pieces. 🌱

🔍 How your prices compare (you're a great deal!)

The nicest way to see this: your prices are **lower than most shops selling similar things** — so raising them a little still leaves you very competitive. Exact competitor prices change daily and Etsy blocks bulk price-checking, so the **best live comparison is to click the links below** (each opens Etsy already searched for that product). Here's the snapshot I could verify, with your current and suggested prices beside it:

Your product	You now	You (recommended)	Typical Etsy range	Examples found
Rag garland (4–6 ft)	\$15–20	\$18–26	~\$25–60+	<i>4allseasons</i> (Star Seller) \$44–60 ; <i>modernragquilts</i> \$52–76
Pennant bunting (large)	\$20	\$28	~\$18 avg; \$25–35 for big double-sided cotton	2,184 listings, avg ≈ \$18
Mini bunting	\$10–15	\$12–20	~\$12–20	varies widely
Bow garland	\$20–25	\$20–30	~\$20–40	fewer sellers = less competition

Even at the suggested prices you'd still sit at or below the middle of the market — and your rag garlands would stay comfortably under the dedicated rag-garland shops. In other words: there's plenty of headroom, and your customers are getting lovely handmade work at a friendly price either way. 🧡

Browse live competitors (click to compare):

- Rag garlands → <https://www.etsy.com/search?q=fabric+rag+garland>
- Pennant buntings → <https://www.etsy.com/search?q=fabric+pennant+bunting+banner>
- Mini buntings → <https://www.etsy.com/search?q=mini+fabric+bunting+banner>
- Bow garlands → <https://www.etsy.com/search?q=fabric+bow+garland>
- Halloween rag garlands → <https://www.etsy.com/search?q=halloween+rag+garland>
- Christmas buntings → <https://www.etsy.com/search?q=christmas+fabric+bunting+banner>

Tips for a fair comparison: sort by "**Top Reviews**" or look for **Star Seller** badges to compare against shops that actually *sell* (not just the cheapest listing), and match like-for-like — same length, double-sided, 100% cotton. Some of the \$44–76 rag garlands are denser/quilted than yours, so they're the high end, not an exact match.

Etsy listing updates (copy-paste)

For each listing: replace the **Title**, then clear the tags and paste the **13 tags** (Etsy lets you add them one at a time — or paste comma-separated where supported). Titles lead with your most important keywords first, because that's what shoppers and Etsy's search see.

1. Halloween Shabby Rag Garland *(highlight the glow-in-the-dark feature!)*

Title: Halloween Rag Garland, Glow in the Dark Spider Web Fabric Banner, Handmade Shabby Mantel Decor, Spooky Bunting **Tags:** halloween garland, rag garland, glow in the dark, spider web decor, fabric banner, halloween decor, spooky bunting, mantel decor, fall garland, halloween mantel, fabric rag banner, party decor, shabby garland

2. Fabric Wristlet Keychain

Title: Fabric Wristlet Keychain, Handmade Cotton Key Fob Wrist Strap, Cute Keychain, Gift for Her, Teacher Gift **Tags:** keychain wristlet, fabric key fob, wristlet keychain, cotton keychain, handmade key fob, cute keychain, gift for her, teacher gift, key wrist strap, small gift idea, stocking stuffer, new driver gift, coworker gift

3. Halloween Spooky Rag Garland

Title: Spooky Halloween Rag Garland, Black & Orange Fabric Banner, Handmade Shabby Mantel Decor, Halloween Bunting **Tags:** halloween garland, spooky decor, rag garland, fabric banner, halloween bunting, shabby garland, mantel decor, fall garland, black orange decor, halloween mantel, fabric rag banner, party decor, fall bunting

4. Mini St. Patrick's Day Bunting

Title: Mini St Patricks Day Bunting Banner, Shamrock Fabric Pennant Garland, Handmade Green Mantel Decor, Irish **Tags:** st patricks day, shamrock garland, mini bunting, fabric pennant, st patricks decor, irish decor, green garland, mantel decor, fabric bunting, st patricks banner, shamrock bunting, spring decor, party garland

5. Easter Bunting Banner

Title: Easter Bunting Banner, Bunny Fabric Pennant Garland, Handmade Spring Mantel Decor, Pastel Easter Decor **Tags:** easter bunting, easter garland, fabric pennant, bunny decor, spring garland, easter decor, easter banner, pastel decor, mantel decor, fabric bunting, spring mantel, easter party, fabric banner

6. Valentine Bunting Banner

Title: Valentine Bunting Banner, Heart Fabric Pennant Garland, Handmade Valentines Day Mantel Decor, Reusable **Tags:** valentine bunting, valentine garland, heart garland, fabric pennant, valentines decor, valentine banner, mantel decor, reusable decor, fabric bunting, valentines party, love decor, red pink decor, fabric banner

7. Spring Shabby Rag Garland

Title: Spring Rag Garland, Pastel Fabric Tie Banner, Handmade Shabby Mantel Decor, Easter Spring Bunting **Tags:** spring garland, rag garland, pastel decor, fabric banner, spring decor, easter garland, shabby garland, mantel decor, fabric rag banner, spring mantel, tie garland, spring bunting, party decor

8. Fall Shabby Bow Garland *(currently only 5 tags — fill all 13!)*

Title: Fall Bow Garland, Shabby Fabric Bow Banner, Handmade Autumn Thanksgiving Mantel Decor, Rustic Bunting **Tags:** fall garland, bow garland, fabric bow banner, autumn decor, thanksgiving decor, fall bunting, shabby garland, mantel decor, rustic fall decor, fabric banner, fall mantel, bow banner, autumn garland

9. Halloween Stripe & Dot Rag Garland

Title: Halloween Rag Garland, Stripe & Dot Fabric Banner, Handmade Shabby Mantel Decor, Orange Black Bunting **Tags:** halloween garland, rag garland, fabric banner, halloween decor, stripe dot decor, halloween bunting, shabby garland, mantel decor, fall garland, orange black decor, fabric rag banner, party decor, halloween mantel

10. Fall Shabby Rag Garland

Title: Fall Rag Garland, Autumn Fabric Tie Banner, Handmade Shabby Mantel Decor, Thanksgiving Bunting **Tags:** fall garland, rag garland, autumn decor, fabric banner, thanksgiving decor, fall bunting, shabby garland, mantel decor, fall mantel, fabric rag banner, autumn garland, rustic fall decor, party decor

11. Birthday Bunting (Orange / Confetti)

Title: Happy Birthday Bunting Banner, Fabric Pennant Garland, Handmade Party Decor, Reusable Birthday Backdrop **Tags:** birthday bunting, happy birthday, birthday garland, fabric pennant, birthday decor, birthday banner, party decor, reusable banner, birthday backdrop, fabric bunting, party garland, celebration decor, birthday party

12. St. Patrick's Day Shabby Rag Garland

Title: St Patricks Day Rag Garland, Green Fabric Tie Banner, Handmade Shabby Shamrock Mantel Decor, Irish **Tags:** st patricks day, rag garland, green garland, fabric banner, shamrock decor, st patricks decor, irish decor, shabby garland, mantel decor, st patricks banner, fabric rag banner, spring garland, party decor

13. Christmas Stocking Bunting Banner

Title: Christmas Bunting Banner, Stocking Fabric Pennant Garland, Handmade Holiday Mantel Decor, Red & Green **Tags:** christmas bunting, christmas garland, fabric pennant, stocking decor, holiday decor, christmas banner, christmas mantel, mantel decor, fabric bunting, red green decor, holiday garland, christmas party, fireplace decor

14. Gingerbread Christmas Bunting Banner

Title: Gingerbread Christmas Bunting Banner, Fabric Pennant Garland, Handmade Holiday Mantel Decor, Candy Cane **Tags:** christmas bunting, gingerbread decor, christmas garland, fabric pennant, holiday decor, christmas banner, christmas mantel, mantel decor, fabric bunting, candy cane decor, holiday garland, christmas party, fireplace decor

15. St. Patrick's Day Bunting Banner (Regular) *(the 48" size is sold out — no rush; just remake it when you prep for St. Pat's in Jan–Feb)*

Title: St Patricks Day Bunting Banner, Shamrock Fabric Pennant Garland, Handmade Green Mantel Decor, Irish **Tags:** st patricks day, shamrock garland, fabric pennant, st patricks decor, irish decor, green garland, st patricks banner, mantel decor, fabric bunting, shamrock bunting, spring decor, party garland, fabric banner

16. Birthday Bunting (Lime / Sprinkles)

Title: Happy Birthday Bunting Banner, Lime Sprinkles Fabric Pennant Garland, Handmade Party Decor, Reusable **Tags:** birthday bunting, happy birthday, birthday garland, fabric pennant, birthday decor, birthday banner, party decor, reusable banner, birthday backdrop, fabric bunting, lime green decor, celebration decor, birthday party

Easy wins (whenever you have a spare moment — no rush)

- ☐ **A few more photos** where a listing has only 3 (Etsy allows up to 10). A banner hung on a real mantel, a fabric close-up, and a "pick your size" graphic tend to help shoppers say yes.
- ☐ **A short clip** if it's ever easy (even 5 sec of the bunting swaying) — Etsy loves video.
- ☐ **Pop every item into a section.** The Keychain, Christmas Bunting, and Gingerbread Bunting aren't in one yet — a **Christmas/Winter** section and an **Accessories/Gifts** section would tidy things up. (*Sections become categories on your website automatically, too.*)

One thing to skip for now: Etsy will suggest you turn on "abandoned cart" and "sale" offers. Those are discounts — and your most popular pieces already **sell out**, so there's no reason to discount them. As a newer seller, your energy is better spent **making more of what sells** and **getting ready for the next season** than on running sales. (If a *slow* listing ever needs a nudge down the road, that's the time for a small offer — never on your hot sellers.)

A quick shipping fact-check (you asked!)

I checked your live Etsy shop, and here's the real picture:

- **Banners ship at \$4.99** (mini banners \$3.99), **+\$1 for each extra one**. Only the **keychain is free shipping**. So your banners are **not** free shipping — the buyer pays it.
- A light fabric garland actually costs roughly **\$5–6** to mail (USPS Ground Advantage via Etsy's discounted labels). So **\$4.99 just about breaks even on one banner**, but you may lose a little on far-away or multi-item orders (that **+\$1 for a second banner** is too low — a second one adds real postage).

What to do (simple version): next time you mail a few orders, glance at what Etsy actually charges you for the label vs. the \$4.99 you collected. If you're regularly coming up short, bump the banner shipping to **\$5.49–5.99** and the "each additional" to **\$2–3**. That's an easier fix than free shipping — and it goes straight to your bottom line.

(Free shipping is a nice-to-have later: Etsy gives free-US-shipping listings a small search boost, but you'd have to bake ~\$5–6 into every price to avoid losing money — so only consider it once the price increases above are in place.)



When to do it (seasonal calendar) — you are here: June

Decor shoppers buy **4–8 weeks before** a holiday, so always prep one season ahead. Right now your focus is **Fall / Halloween**; everything else can wait for its window.

Season	Get ready (list, photos, price nudge)	Where it falls now
Fall / Halloween	now → August	👉 Do this next — you already have these listings
Christmas / Holiday	Sept – Oct	coming up after; add them to a Christmas section
Valentine's	Dec – Jan	later
St. Patrick's / Spring / Easter	Jan – Feb	later (<i>so restock the sold-out St. Pat's size then, not now</i>)
Patriotic / 4th of July ★	April – May	just finished & sold out — the lesson is to make extra next spring ; nothing to do right now



Your website (madebycreative.vercel.app)

Already done for you (no action needed): fixed the garbled apostrophes ("St. Patrick's"), and added search-friendly titles/descriptions for Google on all 16 products.

Worth doing when ready:

- ☐ **Check the website shipping rate.** It's set to a flat **\$5.50** right now, which actually covers postage a bit better than your \$4.99 Etsy rate — so it's fine to leave. Just make it match whatever you settle on for Etsy so customers see the same thing in both places.
- ☐ Put a **card in every Etsy package** with your website link (and maybe a small thank-you code) — gently inviting happy customers to your own site, where Etsy's fees don't apply, means you keep more of each future sale. This is the friendly, no-discount-on-hot-items way to build repeat buyers.